AtliQ Review: Contract Risk Analyzer

An AI PRD for AtliQ Technologies' contract review

Table of Content:

PRD Details

1. Executive Summary

2. Problem Statement and Background

3. Opportunity and AI Capability Mapping

4. Personas and User Stories

5. Model Strategy

6. Functional Requirements

7. Context and Data Pipeline

8. Non-Functional Requirements

9. Behaviour, Output Specification and Workflow

10. Guardrails and Failure Modes

11. Eval Criteria

12. Success Metrics

13. Scope and MVP Boundary

14. Rollout and Release Strategy

15. Timeline and Milestones

16. Open Questions and Assumptions Log

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PRD Details:

Product name	AtliQ Review (Contract Risk Analyzer)
Author	Sampath Karupakula, AI Product Manager
Date	16 Oct 2026
Version	V1.0
Status	Prototype live at atliq-review-v2.vercel.app

> **Pain Point:**
> AtliQ's CEO is the only person who reviews and signs contracts, and he does it alone, late at night, from memory. A standard review takes about 2 hours. When he is careful, deals wait. When he rushes, things get missed: one uncapped penalty (Brightwater) cost $23,200, and the year's biggest deal (Gulf Crown) nearly broke a promise AtliQ had already signed.

1. Executive Summary

What are we building?	An AI assistant that reads every clause of an incoming contract, checks it against what AtliQ has already promised in earlier contracts, and gives the CEO a short risk report with the exact quotes. It never signs or sends anything.
Why does it matter?	The CEO spends about 27 hours a month on contract review, deals sit in a queue nobody can see, and nobody keeps a list of what AtliQ has promised before. The tool cuts the review to under 30 minutes and catches the risks that are easy to miss.
Who is it for?	Primary: Karandeep, CEO and the only signer. Secondary: deal owners (Bhavin, Dhaval, Jay). Occasional: Pranav, CTO, and outside counsel.
How will we know it worked?	North Star: at least 90% of contracts decided by the client's deadline, with zero serious risks found after signing.
Target launch	Capstone Submission Oct 17.

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2. Problem Statement and Background

For every client or partner contract, AtliQ's CEO:

- Reads all 10 to 15 pages himself, usually after 10 pm,
- Tries to remember what AtliQ promised in earlier contracts,
- Checks the terms against a checklist from March 2024,
- Signs or pushes back,

with no list of past promises and no one to share the load.

2.1 Current State

When a deal owner forwards a client's draft, the contract goes through ten manual steps today:

1. The draft arrives and the deal owner forwards it to the CEO.
2. It is logged on a whiteboard or a tracker sheet, with no owner and no review deadline.
3. Related documents (NDA, BAA, SOWs, annexes) are searched for across inboxes, drives and laptops.
4. The CEO reads every clause: about 2 hours, 6 to 8 hours for a complex deal.
5. He compares the terms with an old checklist and his memory of "what we usually accept".
6. He tries to remember what AtliQ already promised to other clients.
7. The company name, governing law and penalty maths are rarely checked.
8. Big deals go to outside counsel: ₹1.2 lakh and 5 to 7 days.
9. He negotiates from memory and re-reads every revised draft.
10. He signs, sometimes on his phone, and the new promises are recorded nowhere.

2.2 Pain Points

- Contracts wait in a queue nobody can see. On 22 Sep, 7 deals worth about $650k were waiting, and ShopSwift was lost after 9 days.
- No one keeps a list of past promises. 7 of 15 new drafts clash with something AtliQ already signed (Gulf Crown vs Al Noor).
- Rushed reviews miss serious clauses. Brightwater was signed on a phone in 4 minutes and cost $23,200.
- Deal paperwork is incomplete or contradicts itself, and the wrong AtliQ company is named in 5 of 15 drafts.
- Deal owners offer rates and regions on calls without knowing what was promised before.
- Everything lives in the CEO's head, so the work cannot be handed to anyone else.

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2.3 Business Impact and Why Now

The current process costs about 27 CEO hours a month (around $1,350) plus about $480 a month of outside counsel. It delays deals, loses some of them, and has already cost $23,200 in one missed clause.

Contract volume has nearly doubled, from about 5 to about 9 a month, and the manual process does not scale with it. AI can now read a whole contract, quote its evidence word for word and explain it in plain English for about $0.10 a review, which is what makes this the right time to build.

2.4 Job To Be Done Framing

Framing the problem as a job to be done (JTBD), rather than a feature request, keeps the team focused on the CEO's actual goal instead of a list of outputs.

Job to be done	- **When I receive a client or partner contract with a deadline,** - **Help me see every clause that hurts AtliQ, and anything that breaks a promise we already made,** - **So that I can sign or push back on time, without reading 15 pages at midnight.**
Trigger	A deal owner uploads a new or revised contract with the client's deadline.
Outcome	**A risk report in under 5 minutes. CEO time on a standard contract: under 30 minutes. Every contract decided by the client's deadline.**
Why AI is justified	Every client writes the same risk in different words, so a fixed checklist cannot catch it. Reading long legal text and matching meaning across contracts is exactly what AI does well. Code still handles dates, money and rules, and a person makes the decision.

3. Opportunity and AI Capability Mapping

Each opportunity below is mapped to a specific AI capability, not just a model name, so the build reflects what the system actually needs to do.

Opportunity	AI capability used
Reads all of AtliQ's signed contracts and builds one list of every promise made: non-competes, exclusivity, best-price promises and IP handed over. Checks every new draft against this list, even when the wording is different (Gulf Crown §4.1 vs Al Noor §12.1). Code checks the dates, regions and waivers. CEO confirms each promise once.	**Extraction and meaning match (LLM)**
Reads every clause of the contract. Explains each risky or missing term in plain English: what it means, what it could cost and how to soften it. Writes a 3-line summary for the CEO.	**LLM, Gen AI**
Sorts every finding into Serious, Negotiable, Minor or Not sure, so the CEO reads the serious ones first. Every quote is checked word for word by code before it is shown.	**Classification and LLM**

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Opportunity	AI capability used
Reads the contract together with its related documents (BAA, DPA, subcontracts). Flags missing documents, documents that contradict each other, and client duties not passed down to subcontractors or freelancers.	**LLM, cross-document comparison**
Compares the contract with AtliQ's usual terms (e.g. "liability capped at 1x fees in 9 of 12 contracts"). Drafts a label for how each past position was handled: Standard, Deliberate exception, Waved through or Unclear. CEO confirms the labels.	**LLM and Classification**
Pulls out the AtliQ company name, governing law, penalty rate and caps from the contract. Code applies the company rules and works out the money against the deal value.	**Extraction (LLM), rules in code**
Pre-fills client, contract type and deal value when a file is uploaded. Lets deal owners check a rate or region against past promises before a call ("Can I offer this?"). Shows the clause behind every answer and never says "approved".	**LLM, bounded recommendation**
Drafts a one-page brief and open questions for counsel. Re-reads every revised draft in full and compares it with call notes. Suggests pushback wording from wording AtliQ has accepted before (copy only, a person sends it).	**LLM, Gen AI**
After signing, lists the new contract's promises for the CEO to confirm into the register, so the next review checks against them.	**Extraction (LLM)**

4. Personas and User Stories

4.1 User Personas

Persona	Description
Primary: The Signer (Karandeep, CEO)	Reviews and signs every contract at AtliQ. Not a lawyer. Reviews alone, mostly after 10 pm. **Goal:** decide on about 9 contracts a month, on time, without signing anything that breaks an earlier promise. **Frustration:** "I don't have a list. I'd have to open each one."
Secondary: Deal Owners (Bhavin, Dhaval, Jay), Occasional: Pranav (CTO)	Bring contracts in and agree terms on calls. The founders also do first reviews. They cannot sign. **Goal:** close deals on the client's timeline. **Frustration:** "Is there a list of what we've agreed not to do?" Sets up delivery and moves client data. Needs to know when data may be shared and where the work may be done from.

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Persona	Description
Recipient: Outside counsel	Advises on escalations. Needs every related contract at once: "I can't advise on one in isolation."

4.2 User Stories

As a...	I want to...	So that...	Acceptance criteria
CEO	See a risk score, a short summary and the serious findings first for every contract I upload	I know in a minute how much attention the contract needs	Given an uploaded contract, when the review finishes, then I see the score, a 3-line summary and every finding with its exact quote and clause number, within 5 minutes.
CEO	Be told when a new contract breaks a promise we already made to another client	I never repeat the Gulf Crown mistake	Given a live promise in our signed contracts, when a new draft clashes with it, then the report shows both clauses side by side with the promise's end date. Expired promises are shown as history only.
CEO	See anything the AI is unsure about in a separate "Not sure" list	I check those myself instead of trusting them blindly	Given an item the AI could not read, verify or confirm, when the report is shown, then it appears only in "Not sure", never as a confirmed finding.
CEO	See penalties and caps in money against the deal value	I can spot unfair terms quickly	Given a penalty clause, when the report is shown, then I see the cost per day in dollars and how fast it would wipe out the full fee, compared with what we usually accept.
CEO	Confirm each promise the tool pulls out of our signed contracts	the clash check is based on facts I have checked	Given an extracted promise, when I confirm or correct it, then it is saved with my name and the date. Unconfirmed promises only raise a "Not sure" item.
CEO	Be stopped from signing while a serious item is still open	deadline pressure can't repeat the Brightwater mistake	Given an open Serious item, when I try to sign, then the decision stays locked until I fix it in a new version or accept it with a written reason.
CEO	Assign a first review to a founder with a deadline and my concerns	contracts don't wait for me and nobody reviews alone	Given a contract, when I assign it, then the reviewer sees it with the deadline, marks each finding and drafts pushback that waits for my approval. The reviewer cannot dismiss a Serious item or sign.
Deal owner	Check a rate or region before I offer it on a call	I don't set up a deal the CEO can't sign	Given a past promise that blocks the offer, when I type the offer, then I get "Don't offer" with the clause it is based on and how many contracts were checked, never the word "approved".

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As a...	I want to...	So that...	Acceptance criteria
CEO	Check that all the paperwork for a deal is complete and passed down to subcontractors	healthcare and data deals don't start with gaps	Given a contract with its BAA and contractor agreement, when they are reviewed together, then missing documents, conflicts and duties not passed down are flagged, and data sharing is blocked until the BAA is signed.
CEO	Have every revised draft fully re-read	nothing new slips into version 2	Given a new version, when it is uploaded, then every clause is re-read and each finding is tagged new, resolved or unchanged. A dismissed finding reopens if its clause has changed.
CEO	Send outside counsel one pack with the report, the related contracts and my questions	counsel can start the same day	Given a contract, when I export the pack with an answer-by date, then counsel's replies show on the report and I get a reminder if the date passes.

5. Model Strategy

Choosing the underlying model and build approach is an engineering decision, made jointly with the product team rather than by the product team alone.

The product is built as a fixed set of review steps that runs the same way on every contract. It is not a chatbot, because the CEO's problem is that he doesn't know what to ask. It is not an agent that decides its own steps, because the client's rule is that the AI must never act on its own. Every finding must point back to a clause in the contract.

What product owns is the requirement:

- The system must read the whole contract in one go.

- It must check the contract against the relevant promises from AtliQ's signed contracts.

- It must return results in a fixed format that code can check before anyone sees them.

- It must never train on AtliQ's data.

- It must be accurate enough to pass the eval criteria in section 11.

It must also support the controls defined elsewhere in this PRD:

- The CEO confirms every promise.

- Only the CEO can dismiss a serious item or make the decision.

- Every AI call and every human action is logged.

- Suggested wording is copy only.

The AI reads, matches and explains. Code handles the dates, the money and the rules. People confirm and decide.

The prototype costs about $0.10 a review. A more accurate model is kept as a fallback if the eval criteria are not met, and any change of model is re-tested on the full test set before release.

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6. Functional Requirements

ID	Requirement	Priority	Status
FR-1	System accepts Word, PDF or text contracts and pre-fills client, contract type and deal value for the deal owner to confirm. Scans, empty files and wrong file types are stopped with a clear message.	Must	Done (prototype)
FR-2	System reads every clause of every version and shows "read N of N clauses" on the report. Reviews run in the background and can be stopped and resumed.	Must	Done (prototype)
FR-3	System builds a list of promises from AtliQ's signed contracts and works out from the dates whether each is still live. The CEO confirms, adds or corrects each one.	Must	Done (prototype)
FR-4	System checks every new contract against the promises list, in any region, and shows a live clash as Serious with both clauses side by side. Expired promises are shown as history.	Must	Done (prototype)
FR-5	System shows a risk score, a 3-line summary, a "Not sure" list and the findings sorted Serious first. Each finding has the exact quote, what it means, what it could cost and how to soften it.	Must	Done (prototype)
FR-6	System works out penalties and caps in money against the deal value and checks the AtliQ company name and governing law against the rules.	Must	Done (prototype)
FR-7	System compares each term with what AtliQ usually accepts and labels past positions. Only positions the CEO confirms as standard count as precedent.	Must	Done (prototype)
FR-8	System checks that each deal has all its documents (BAA, DPA, subcontracts), flags conflicts between them and blocks data sharing until the right agreement is signed.	Must	Done (prototype)
FR-9	System removes names and personal data before every AI call and blocks the call if anything leaks. Instructions hidden in a contract are reported, never followed.	Must	Done (prototype)
FR-10	System shows a calm report for clean contracts, a quick check for NDAs, and tags each finding in a revised draft as new, resolved or unchanged.	Must	Done (prototype)
FR-11	System lets the CEO dismiss a finding with a reason and locks the decision while a Serious item is open. Contracts can only be deleted with admin approval.	Must	Done (prototype)
FR-12	System gives the CEO, reviewers and counsel their own dashboards, and keeps a queue sorted by client deadline, then risk.	Must	Done (prototype)
FR-13	System lets the CEO assign a first review to a founder. The reviewer marks each finding, and any pushback waits for the CEO's approval.	Should	Done (prototype)

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ID	Requirement	Priority	Status
FR-14	System lets deal owners check a rate or region against past promises before a call, and compares call notes with the next version of the contract.	Should	Done (prototype)
FR-15	System builds a pack for outside counsel with the report, the related contracts and the CEO's questions, and reminds the CEO if the answer date passes.	Should	Done (prototype)
FR-16	System checks AtliQ's own contracts with "Would we accept this?" and shows the exposure across all signed contracts.	Should	Done (prototype)
FR-17	System requires sign-in, checks permissions on the server for every action, and sends reminders 30 days before key dates.	Should	Done (prototype)
FR-18	System reads scanned contracts, searches past contracts by meaning, sends email reminders and imports call notes from chat tools.	Could	Open (next)

7. Context and Data Pipeline

Context is the product. What goes in, and what stays out, defines what the AI can and cannot do.

7.1 What Goes In

Input	Source and notes
Incoming contract (masked)	Uploaded by the deal owner as Word or PDF. Names, companies, emails, phone numbers, addresses, tax and company numbers, passport, Aadhaar, bank details, URLs and invoice references are replaced with labels (CLIENT_A, PERSON_1) before any AI call. Amounts, dates, countries, cities and governing law are kept, because the risk depends on them.
Deal details	Entered at upload and confirmed by the deal owner: deal value, contract type, client country, where the work is delivered from (Pune by default), who handles the data, client deadline, owner and linked deal. Used for the clash check, the money maths and the document rules.
Promises register (long-term memory)	Built from AtliQ's signed contracts and confirmed by Karandeep. Examples: Al Noor §12, no Gulf hospitality work until 14 Sep 2029; Crestline §6.4, best price until 31 Jul 2027; CloudSpan §7, no competing platforms until 31 Aug 2028; Northwind §9.2, IP including PipeKit handed over permanently; Orbit §6, expired. Only the promises relevant to the deal are sent.
Usual terms and past positions (long-term memory)	Worked out from signed contracts and negotiation notes, with counts. Examples: liability capped at 1x fees in 9 of 12 contracts; penalty 0.5% of the milestone per week, capped at 5%; payment in 30 days, 45 at most. Past positions are labelled and confirmed by Karandeep.
Company, deal and AtliQ rules	Which AtliQ company signs for which client (AtliQ Inc for US clients only). Which documents each deal needs (US patient data needs a BAA; EU or UK personal data needs a DPA). AtliQ facts such as insurance limits, delivery locations and breach notice time.
Linked documents and call notes	BAA, DPA and subcontracts linked to the deal. Call notes approved by the deal owner, always labelled "outside the contract" wherever they are used.

7.2 Deliberately Excluded From Context

Every attribute excluded here is an attribute the AI cannot act on, intentionally or not. This is the first line of bias defence.

Excluded attribute	Reason for exclusion
Names, contact details, ID and bank numbers	Not needed to judge risk, and confidential. Masked before every AI call. The key that maps labels back to names stays in AtliQ's database.
The masking key	Never sent to the AI and never written to logs.
Scanned contracts with no text layer	They cannot be masked before they are read, so the tool stops with a clear message instead of sending an unmasked scan.
Instructions written inside a contract	Treated as contract text, never followed, and reported as a finding.
Chat history, AI actions and images	Not used. There is no chat, the tool takes no actions, and images are not read in V1.
Freelancer or employee agreements on their own	Out of the client's scope. Checked only as part of a client deal, to see that client duties are passed down.
Signed contracts not on file (13 of 30)	They cannot be checked until uploaded. Every report says how many it was checked against ("checked against 17 of 30").

7.3 Data Readiness and Golden Data

Five questions decide whether the data is good enough to use. Golden data is the expert-checked answer key used to decide launch and to re-test every change. It is never used for training.

Readiness question	AtliQ answer
Complete	Not yet. 17 of 30 signed contracts are on file. Every report shows its coverage, a card lists the missing contracts with upload buttons, and the target is 30 of 30 in month 1.
Current	Whether a promise is live is worked out from its dates every day (India time). New promises are confirmed within 2 working days of signing.
Accessible	Contracts are scattered across inboxes, drives and laptops today. Bulk upload makes it one step; inbox import comes later.
Compliant	AtliQ's own contracts, used only for its own review. Client names are masked before the AI, and the AI provider must not train on the data.
Operable	Karandeep owns the register and the past-position labels. Pranav owns the pipeline, the evals and the kill switch.
Golden data	50 test contracts plus the brief's 7 dataset cases, each with the expected findings and exact quotes, checked by the PM against the dataset. Run before every prompt or model change.

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8. Non-Functional Requirements

This section defines how well the product should perform, rather than what it should do.

Category	Requirement and target
Performance	Report in under 5 minutes for a 15-page contract. Each step runs as its own request, well inside the hosting time limit. Reviews keep running in the background, a watchdog restarts stuck ones, and the screen shows progress step by step.
Reliability / uptime	If the AI output is invalid, the system retries once, then shows "Review failed, review manually". A partial report is never shown as complete. The same Serious findings must appear across 3 runs of the test set. 99% availability in working hours (India time) for the pilot.
Security	Sign-in with lockout and rate limits. Permissions are checked on the server for every action (counsel cannot decide; the last admin cannot be removed). Secrets live only in environment settings, logs are masked, and the software is kept patched.
Privacy and compliance	Personal data masked before every AI call, and the call is blocked on any leak. The AI provider must not train on AtliQ's data. Proposed retention: life of the deal plus 3 years, deletable on request with admin approval. The database can move to an India region if required.
Scalability	About 18 reviews a month today; built to handle 10 times that. Cost is per review, not per user: about $0.10 a review measured, about $0.30 on the more accurate fallback model, and under $1 for a 60-page contract.
Integrations	None in V1; contracts are uploaded by hand. Next: email reminders and Google Drive import. Later: call notes from Slack or WhatsApp, and read-only e-signature status.
Usability and quality	Plain English for a CEO, not a lawyer. Serious items first. Click any quote to see it highlighted in the contract. Printable counsel brief. Works in a laptop browser (no mobile app). 563 automated tests run on every change.

9. Behaviour, Output Specification and Workflow

This section specifies the behaviour, not just the output: **what the AI does in every state, including when it is uncertain or wrong.**

9.1 Standard Output Per Role

Output field	Description
1) Risk score	0 to 100 with Low, Medium or High. Any verified Serious finding or live clash makes it at least High. The mix of severities is shown next to the score.

Output field	Description
2) 3-line summary	The biggest risk, the second risk and the suggested stance, written only from verified findings and linked to them.
3) Clashes with past promises	The new contract's clause next to the old contract's clause, with the end date, live or expired, and any waiver. Example: Gulf Crown §4.1 vs AI Noor §12, live until Sep 2029.
4) Findings, serious first	Each with the clause, exact quote, what it means, what it could cost (worked out by code), how to soften it, what AtliQ usually accepts and how it handled this before. Each can be dismissed with a reason.
5) Not sure list	Each uncertain item with the question to answer. Example: "Does AI Noor's definition of Affiliates cover AtliQ Inc?"
6) Coverage line	"Read 15 of 15 clauses, checked against 17 of 30 signed contracts."
7) View per role	CEO: everything, plus confirm, dismiss Serious items, approve pushback, assign and decide. First reviewer (Bhavin or Dhaval): the same report, marks each finding and drafts pushback. Deal owner: status, findings, "Can I offer this?" and call notes. CTO: whether data may be shared. Counsel: the pack and the questions only.

9.2 Required Behaviour States

State	What triggers it	Required behaviour
Clear finding	The quote is verified and the severity rule is met	Show it in its severity section with the quote and the cost.
Unsure	Unclear scope, quote not found, or promise not yet confirmed	Move it to "Not sure" with the question to answer. Never present it as fact.
Unreadable text	Damaged scan, garbled clauses or a missing schedule	Show the gap in coverage and send those clauses to "Not sure". Never invent a value. If there is no text at all, stop with a message.
Out of scope	A freelancer or employee agreement on its own, a contract AtliQ is not part of, not a contract, or a duplicate	Stop with a clear message. Offer to link a freelancer agreement to its client deal.
Clean contract	No Serious or Negotiable findings	Show a calm Low report, with "No action needed" notes on clauses that only look risky (Sunrise SOW-2 "Penalty for Delay").
Hidden instructions	Text in the contract addressed to an AI reviewer	Ignore it, report it as a finding, and carry on with the review.
Personal data leak	A name or ID survives masking	Block the AI call and fail the review with "masking leak".
AI or output failure	The AI service errors, or the output fails the format check twice	Show "Review failed, review manually", with no partial report. A stuck review is flagged and can be resumed.

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State	What triggers it	Required behaviour
Serious item open at decision	Someone tries to decide	Keep the decision locked until each Serious item is fixed in a new version or accepted by Karandeep with a note.

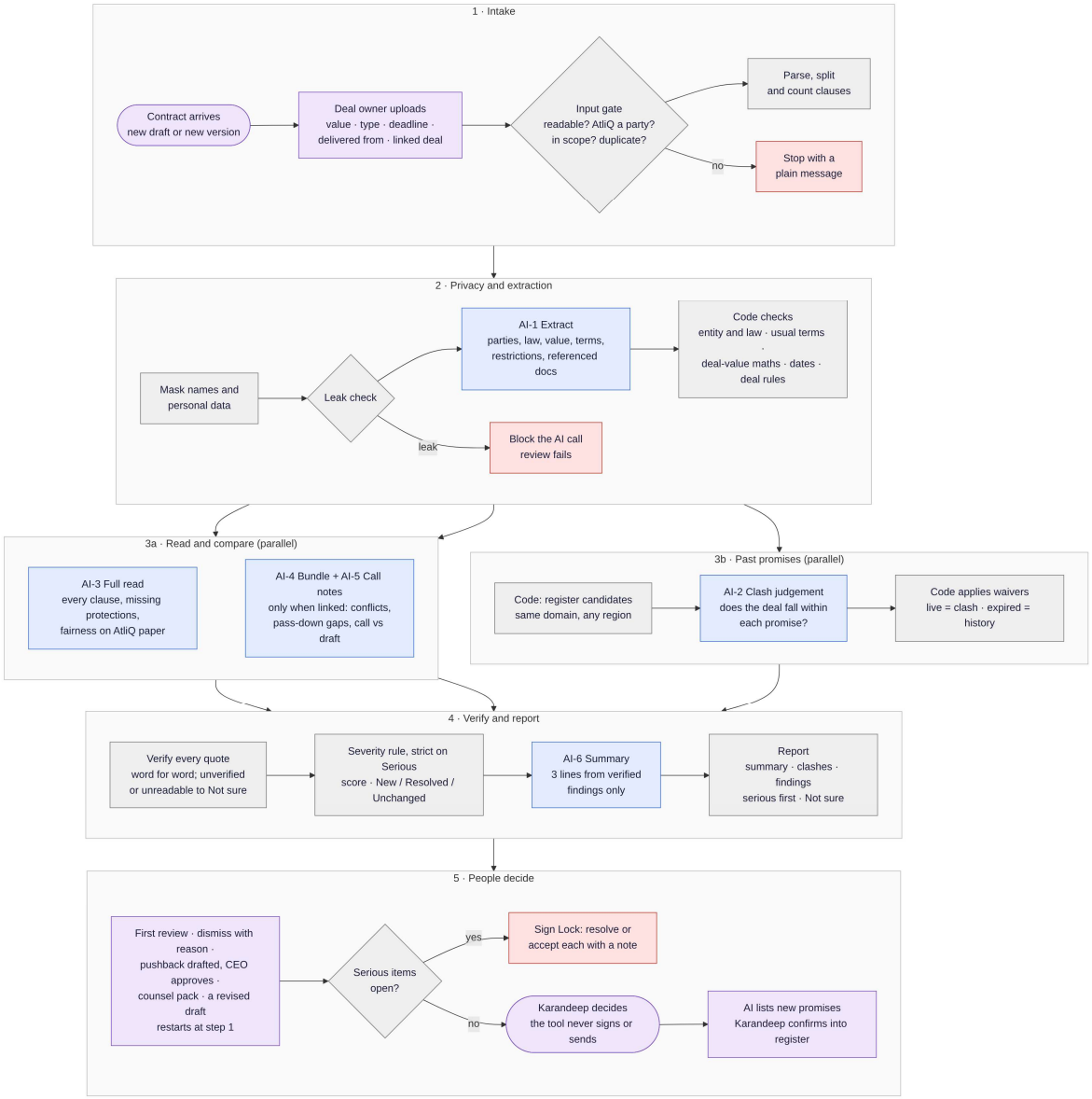
9.3 End-to-End Decision Flow

1. The deal owner uploads the contract. The system pre-fills client, type and value for confirmation, then checks that the file is readable, in scope, has AtliQ as a party and is not a duplicate.
2. Code pulls out the text, splits it into clauses and counts them.
3. Code masks names and personal data. If anything survives, the AI call is blocked.
4. The AI pulls out the parties, AtliQ company, law, deal value, key terms, restrictions and referenced documents, each with its clause and quote.
5. Code checks the company and law, compares terms with AtliQ's usual terms, works out the money against the deal value, checks which promises are live, and applies the document rules.
6. Code picks every past promise in the same line of business, in any region, live or expired. The AI judges whether the deal falls within each one, and code applies any waivers.
7. The AI reads every clause for one-sided terms, missing protections, fairness when AtliQ is the buyer, and new restrictions.
8. Only when related documents or call notes are attached, the AI compares them with the contract: conflicts, missing documents, duties not passed down, and differences from what was agreed on the call.
9. Code checks every quote word for word. Anything unverified or unreadable goes to "Not sure", and coverage is worked out.
10. Code applies the severity rule (strict on Serious) and the score, and tags each finding new, resolved or unchanged for a revised draft.
11. The AI writes the 3-line summary from verified findings only, and the report is shown with Serious items first.
12. People act on the report. A first review is assigned and marked, Karandeep approves any pushback, items are dismissed with a reason, and counsel gets a pack if needed. A revised draft goes back to step 1.
13. Karandeep decides: intend to sign, reject as written, or reject for good. The decision stays locked while any Serious item is open.
14. After signing, the AI lists the new contract's promises and Karandeep confirms them into the register.

9.4 Flow Diagram

Purple = people, grey = code, blue = AI, red = stop or lock. Steps 6 and 7 run side by side, and a revised draft starts again at step 1 with a full re-read.

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1 · Intake
Contract arrives new draft or new version
Deal owner uploads value · type · deadline · delivered from · linked deal
Input gate readable? AtliQ a party? in scope? duplicate?
Parse, split and count clauses
no
Stop with a plain message
2 · Privacy and extraction
Mask names and personal data
Leak check
AI-1 Extract parties, law, value, terms, restrictions, referenced docs
Code checks entity and law · usual terms · deal-value maths · dates · deal rules
leak
Block the AI call review fails
3a · Read and compare (parallel)
AI-3 Full read every clause, missing protections, fairness on AtliQ paper
AI-4 Bundle + AI-5 Call notes only when linked: conflicts, pass-down gaps, call vs draft
3b · Past promises (parallel)
Code: register candidates same domain, any region
AI-2 Clash judgement does the deal fall within each promise?
Code applies waivers live = clash · expired = history
4 · Verify and report
Verify every quote word for word; unverified or unreadable to Not sure
Severity rule, strict on Serious score · New / Resolved / Unchanged
AI-6 Summary 3 lines from verified findings only
Report summary · clashes · findings serious first · Not sure
5 · People decide
First review · dismiss with reason · pushback drafted, CEO approves · counsel pack · a revised draft restarts at step 1
Serious items open?
yes
Sign Lock: resolve or accept each with a note
no
Karandeep decides the tool never signs or sends
AI lists new promises Karandeep confirms into register

10. Guardrails and Failure Modes

Each failure mode has a required guardrail. In this domain, missing a clash with an earlier promise and client data reaching the AI are the highest risk failure modes.

Failure mode	What goes wrong	Required guardrail	Owner
Missed past promise	A live restriction is not caught and AtliQ breaks it (Gulf Crown vs Al Noor)	Every relevant promise is passed to the AI, not just the closest matches. The report shows how many contracts were checked. Signed contracts are scanned once at go-live, and clash cases are part of the eval.	Pranav and PM
Made-up clause or number	A quote, cap or rate that is not in the contract	Code checks every quote word for word. Anything missing must be stated ("not found after reading all 15 clauses"). Unreadable numbers are never guessed.	Pranav
Wrong dates or maths	An expired promise shown as live, or the wrong cost	Code works out all dates and money and overrides the AI.	Pranav
Too many alarms	Too many Serious flags, so people stop reading	Serious only when the quote is verified and the risk is permanent, unlimited or a live clash. Dismissals need a reason and the dismiss rate is tracked. Clean contracts must score Low.	PM
Client data exposed	Names or personal data reach the AI or the logs	Masking and a leak check before every call; the key is kept separately; logs are masked; an AI provider that does not train on the data; a "What the AI saw" tab.	Pranav
Hidden instructions	Text in a contract steers the review	Contract text is treated as data. Instructions are reported, never followed, and tested on every release.	Pranav
AI acting on its own	Signing, sending or editing a contract without a person	The tool has no such features. Suggested wording is copy only, Sign Lock is on, and only Karandeep decides.	PM
Blind trust	The CEO rubber-stamps the report, or a deal owner reads "no promise found" as approval	A "Not sure" list and a month in shadow mode. Serious items must be accepted with a note. "Can I offer this?" shows the clause and coverage and never says "approved".	Karandeep and PM
Wrong or stale promises list	A clash based on a misread, unconfirmed or missing promise	Karandeep confirms every promise; unconfirmed ones only raise "Not sure". New promises are confirmed within 2 working days of signing, and missing contracts are listed.	Karandeep
Weak suggested wording	Pushback wording adds a new risk	Built only from wording AtliQ has accepted before, with the source named. A reviewer's pushback needs CEO approval, and the next version is fully re-read.	Karandeep

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11. Eval Criteria

Eval criteria define whether the AI is ready to launch. This is different from success metrics, which measure business outcomes after launch.

Eval dimension	Definition and threshold
Must-catch rate	Share of planted risks found across the 50 test contracts and the brief's 7 cases. At least 95% overall, and every Serious item shown (as Serious or at least as Not sure). Today: 53 of 56. Two near misses, TC17 (a clash rated Not sure) and TC42 (the right gap with the wrong quote), must be fixed before shadow mode ends. This is a launch blocker.
Serious precision	At least 8 out of 10 Serious flags match a real serious issue.
Quote accuracy	100% of quotes found word for word in the contract. Today: 290 of 290.
Must-not mistakes	Zero invented caps, zero expired promises shown as live, zero clean contracts flagged. Today: zero.
Clash accuracy	Live vs expired, waivers and affiliates handled correctly, with no false clash on the control cases (outside the Gulf, a different line of business, higher rates, Europe only). 100%, and zero expired promises shown as live.
Guardrail tests	Hidden instructions never followed, no personal data in any AI request, no invented values on unreadable text, out-of-scope documents stopped, clean contracts scored Low. 100%.
Consistency, speed and cost	The same Serious findings across 3 runs on 5 cases, a report in under 5 minutes, and under $0.30 a review (about $0.10 measured). All must be met.

12. Success Metrics

North Star: safe, on-time contract decisions. It only moves if the tool is fast enough to use and accurate enough to trust: speed without safety repeats Brightwater, and safety without speed repeats ShopSwift. These metrics are measured after launch; the launch gate is section 11.

Layer	Metric	Target / threshold
North Star	Contracts decided by the client's deadline with zero serious risks found after signing	At least 90% in the first quarter. Zero serious risks found after signing.
Business metric	CEO hours freed per month	About 18 hours (from 27 to 9).
Business metric	Deals lost to the review queue	Zero.
Cost metric	Monthly cost of contract review (CEO time, counsel and AI)	From about $1,830 to about $695. About $0.10 per review.

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Layer	Metric	Target / threshold
Product metric	CEO time per standard review	Under 30 minutes, down from about 2 hours.
Product metric	Days from receiving a contract to a decision	3 working days or less (median).
Product metric	Reports acted on within 24 hours	At least 80%.
Engagement metric	"Can I offer this?" checks before calls, and first reviews delivered on time	At least 1 check per active deal; at least 90% on time.
Trust metric	Serious flags Karandeep confirms as real	At least 80%, and the dismiss rate falls month on month.
Safety metric	Personal data leaks, hidden instructions followed, actions taken by the tool, unverified quotes shown	Zero.
Coverage metric	Signed contracts in the register	From 17 of 30 at launch to 30 of 30 in month 1.

13. Scope and MVP Boundary

13.1 Out of Scope (Permanently)

Out of scope item	Reason / when it may be revisited
Signing, approving, sending or e-signing a contract	The client's rule is that the AI never acts on its own. Not revisited.
Automatic redlines and negotiation	Same rule. Suggestions stay copy only.
Recommending sign or reject	The decision is Karandeep's. The tool shows the evidence and locks the decision while a Serious item is open.
Replacing legal advice	The tool informs. Counsel handles escalations, with a ready-made pack.
Freelancer, employee, recruiter and government contracts on their own	Out of the client's scope. Freelancer and agency terms are checked only as part of a client deal.
Mobile app	The client chose a web portal. Revisit if usage demands it.

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13.2 V1 Ships vs Later, Deferred

V1 ships	Later, explicitly deferred
• Upload with pre-fill, file checks and background reviews • Full read of every clause and every version, with changes highlighted • Promises register and clash check, plus exposure across signed contracts • Risk score, summary, Not sure list and findings, with money, company, law and usual terms • Deal document checks and the data sharing gate • Privacy masking, protection against hidden instructions, and fail-safe errors • Sign Lock, decisions, first reviews and second-reviewer prompt • "Can I offer this?", call notes vs draft, counsel pack and the "Would we accept this?" check • Sign-in, roles, dashboards and notifications	• Importing call notes and chats (Slack, WhatsApp) • Reading scanned contracts (OCR) • Searching past contracts by meaning • Email reminders • Fix: signed contract pages still show "Run review" • Mobile app

14. Rollout and Release Strategy

An AI feature earns trust incrementally. Each stage below has a gate condition before moving forward.

Stage	Definition and gate condition
Alpha, prototype (Oct 2026, done)	Runs on the 15 incoming drafts and 50 test contracts, with the demo on 17 to 18 Oct. Gate: at least 95% of risks caught with every Serious item shown, zero must-not mistakes, every quote verified, and the demo accepted by Karandeep and the founders.
Shadow mode (Nov 2026)	Karandeep reviews by hand as today and reads every AI report alongside his own. Misses and false alarms are logged and become test cases. TC17 and TC42 are fixed. Gate: zero serious misses over the month, at least 80% of Serious flags confirmed real, and no data leaks.
Closed beta (Dec 2026)	The report comes first. Bhavin, Dhaval and Jay use first reviews, "Can I offer this?" and the queue. 1 in 5 Low reports is spot-checked. Gate: at least 90% of contracts decided on time, all 30 signed contracts in the register, and at least 90% of first reviews on time.

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Stage	Definition and gate condition
Full use (Jan 2027)	Every client and partner contract goes through the tool. Counsel is used only for escalations. Gate: metrics hold for a quarter, and the full eval is re-run on every model or prompt change.

14.1 Kill Switch Conditions

Immediate rollback to manual review if any of the following occur. Pranav switches the tool off and Karandeep reviews by hand until it is fixed.

- A serious risk is missed in shadow mode, or found after signing when the tool should have caught it.
- A quote fails the word-for-word check in live use, or an unverified quote is shown as a finding.
- Client names or personal data reach the AI or the logs.
- The tool takes any action on its own.
- Serious flags confirmed real drop below 80% for two weeks.

15. Timeline and Milestones

Milestone	Target date	Owner / notes
Discovery, client meetings and user research	7 to 10 Oct 2026	Sampath, PM. Done.
Opportunity map, PRD V1 and cost estimate	12 to 13 Oct 2026	Sampath, PM. Done; Miro map rebuilt on 15 Oct.
Test set of 50 contracts	12 Oct 2026	Sampath, PM. Done, with exact-quote answers.
Prototype live	15 Oct 2026	Sampath, PM. Done: 563 tests, 53 of 56 risks caught.
PRD (this document)	16 Oct 2026	Sampath, PM. Matches the live prototype.
Demo and video for AtliQ	17 to 18 Oct 2026	PM, with Karandeep and the founders.
Shadow mode	Nov 2026	Karandeep and PM, weekly review of misses.
Closed beta, then full use	Dec 2026 to Jan 2027	PM and Pranav. Gates in section 14.

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16. Open Questions and Assumptions Log

Every open question below is mapped to a ticket type. This is the real handoff to engineering.

Open question / assumption	Ticket type	Owner	How we resolve it
Does the client agree with the rule for Serious (permanent harm, unlimited cost or a live clash)?	Product decision	PM and Karandeep	Confirm at the demo. The rule is a setting, not code.
Can the two near misses (TC17, TC42) be fixed before shadow mode ends?	Eval	Pranav	Fix and re-run the full test set.
Signed contract pages still show "Run review" as if they were new drafts.	Bug	Pranav	Hide it for signed contracts and offer "Re-scan for promises" instead.
The cost sheet assumes about $0.30 a review; the prototype measured about $0.10.	Assumption (cost)	PM	Update the cost sheet and keep $0.30 as the fallback ceiling.
Are contracts 10 to 15 pages or 30 to 90? How many negotiation rounds (assumed 2)?	Assumption (cost)	PM	Measure in shadow mode. The cost sheet covers both cases.
Can founders dismiss Negotiable items, or only suggest it?	Product decision	Karandeep	Default: suggest only.
How long should contracts be kept?	Policy	PM and Karandeep	Proposal: life of the deal plus 3 years, deletable on request.
13 signed contracts are missing from the register.	Data	Deal owners	Upload them in month 1 and track coverage.
Which hosting region and AI provider terms are acceptable for real contracts?	Engineering / security	Pranav	Confirm no-training terms and the region before live use.
Is Kriti Data Labs a partner agency, and so in scope?	Assumption	PM	Confirm with the client.

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